Bodo Cultural Heritage: Jotha

Category: INSTRUMENT | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

Bodoland Tourism culture page (tourism.bodoland.gov.in); Anahad Foundation musical archives

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

The Jotha is a pair of small, handheld traditional metallic cymbals made from bell metal or brass, joined together with a stout cotton cord. It serves as an indispensable rhythmic percussion instrument in traditional Bodo musical ensembles. When struck together with quick, glancing wrist movements, the Jotha produces sharp, shimmering high-frequency beats that punctuate the rhythmic patterns of the Kham drum and Siphung flute during the Bagurumba dance, Bwisagu festive songs, and Kherai ceremonies.